Minister and his team were on-board the train. But due to the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation's (DMRC) foresight, the power cut was never noticed!

How Delhi Metro Overcame Murphy's Law

> On 24 December 2002, when the Prime Minister of India was to open the first section, DMRC had only one substation at Kashmere Gate feeding 220 kV. While highly unlikely, there was still an apparent risk of system failure .
>
> Many other organizations might have overlooked such a risk, but DMRC was committed to displaying its quality and insisted on a backup, but there was no alternative available. However, the concerned DMRC official noticed that the Northern Railways have an independent supply at Dadri and a substation at Sahibabad. DMRC requested them for help and laid one line till Shahdara (25 kV) as a backup arrangement, at an extra cost.
>
> On 24 December, the PM was the first citizen to take a ride on the Metro. The journey started at 10.10 a.m. and then, at 10.20, the power supply was disrupted. Within a minute the backup system took over without anyone even noticing the failure of the primary system.
>
> On the day of the inauguration of the Metro, with the who's who of Indian politics on board, and with the media watching, falling prey to Murphy's Law was averted, since careful preparation and commitment had been put in place to go the extra mile, and the embarrassment was avoided.
>
> —Satish Kumar, Director (Electrical)/DMRC
> during an interaction with students of the Indian
> Institute of Management, Ahmedabad. [15 0]

SHAKUNTALA RAILWAY—TRAVELLING BACK IN TIME

The Shakuntala Express remains a symbol of romanticism. It has nothing to do with Kalidasa and his Sanskrit work *Abhijñāna Shākuntalam* , but is a vestige of the British Raj era. The line is one of the last pieces of the colonial railway legacy that was never nationalized. The result—the railways still pays the Central Provinces Railway company that technically owns the line.

The story goes that a British firm, Killick, Nixon and Company, set up in 1857, created the Central Provinces Railway Company (CPRC) to act as its agents. The company built a 2 foot 6 inch (762 mm) narrow gauge line in 1910 to carry cotton from the interior areas of Vidarbha to the Murtajapur junction on the main broad gauge line to Mumbai, from where it would be shipped to Manchester in England. [151] Murtajapur junction was the focal point of this railway, and the train was popularly known as 'Vidarbha Queen'.